Triggers

Triggers & Software Engineering

Controversial because confuses control flow:

- Separate from other code affecting tables.
- Order of multiple triggers is confusing.
- Combining CHECK constraints, triggers, DB functions, & application manipulation of data makes control flow complicated.

Best Practices

Use triggers for only

- Computing derived values
- Auditing
- Adding values to table inaccessible to application

Best Practices

Should triggers include

- Data integrity or consistency rules?
- Arbitrary business rules?

Consensus: OK if simple.